crisis, Indian analysts argued that China had fooled India into accepting the term 'Line of Actual Control' in these agreements. Since the LAC was subsequently never defined – apparently because Beijing refused, arguing that the process would only cause more contention – Chinese troops could continue to press forward. The LAC would then be defined, at any given moment, by wherever China chose to stop its troops.[118] In hindsight this may have turned out to be the case, but at the time India's strategic community was very positive on the two agreements, at least in public.

Unfortunately, the confidence-building measures failed to build enough confidence. By 2008, India was claiming that the Chinese military was increasingly intruding into areas that they had so far left alone. When asked about the growing incidence of intrusions, General V.K. Singh, Chief of the Indian Army, attempted to defuse the stir in the media by suggesting that both sides were to blame and that it was all fairly routine:

> I think at times things get unnecessarily blown up. There are no intrusions. There are transgressions. Transgressions are in areas where a certain alignment is disputed between the two countries. You [India] feel that the alignment should be at a particular place and you go up to that place. They [China] feel that the alignment should be at a particular place, so he comes up to that place . . . There is nothing very alarming about it.[119]

Assuming that both militaries were indeed to blame, why suddenly was there an increase in incursions? General Singh blamed the fuzzy nature of the border and the unwitting actions of patrols. Another possibility is that the incursions were probes designed to test the other side's reconnaissance capabilities, alacrity of response, and willpower. Straying across the LAC may also have been part of a tacit system used by the two militaries to signal their respective claims – in other words, they were reminders. Finally, the intrusions that became confrontations may have occurred as a result of the improvements in infrastructure on both sides of the border. Owing to these improvements, Indian and Chinese troops were able to patrol further and longer than before, taking them into regions where they came face to face for more extended periods of time. Where they once used to patrol intermittently, they were now in a position to visit more frequently. With better intelligence, communications, and infrastructure, they were able